



Apple richer than the US?

Apple's most recent financial results had put its cash reserves at around \$76 billion, \$3 billion more than the US treasury – for 3 days!



Happy birthday!

"Happy Birthday to you" is a copyrighted song and its copyright was purchased for \$5 million by Warner Chappell

Sony PlayStation Vita to launch this October, in a 'phased global release'

A leaked flyer from Blockbuster in the United Kingdom has revealed that the PlayStation Vita, or the Android-based Next Generation Portable we are all waiting for, will be launching by October 28th this year. While Blockbuster has not confirmed the veracity of the flyer, it ties in with last week's rumours of the Vita emerging by the Fall.

Speaking to gaming site IGN, Sony confirmed that the PS Vita will be launching with a 'phased global release' in the 'holiday season.' European pricing of the product was also seen on the flier, at £229.99 for the Wi-Fi only version, and



£279.99 for the Wi-Fi+3G version. The price's rather extravagant compared to the already confirmed U.S. pricing of \$249 and \$299 respectively.

Sony hopes to breathe some life into its aging portable platform with the PS Vita, it looks like it will have a strong chance – it has a list of major launch

titles (revealed at E3 2011); the apps of the entire Android platform; as well as the hardware to back it all up – with a Tegra 3 'Kal-El' processor quad-core Cortex A9-based processor and SGX543MP4+ graphics; as well as multiple input interfaces from gyroscopes to touchpads, analog

sticks to a 5-inch OLED touch-screen. Check out our previous coverage for more details about the PlayStation Vita.

Meanwhile, it looks like Sony is strengthening the Vita's platform before launch, by giving out free development kits. Rubicon Development, an independent developer, has revealed in a report that it has received dev kits from the Japanese giant. Speaking to IGN, Steve Haggerty of Rubicon said:

"We've worked with Apple, and you can't get anything out of them. Microsoft rarely responds and I suppose Nintendo are okay, but Sony are always there to help. They always get back to you." **d**

Asus Eee PC X101 launched in India; a MeeGo netbook for ₹12,499

Asus has launched a new netbook in India, called the Eee PC X101. It has arrived here ahead of several major international territories, such as the U.S. and Europe, where it is expected in the next couple of weeks. Priced at ₹12,499, the 10.1-inch netbook bears a very basic hardware configuration, and we wonder just how well it will do in the market, when there are plenty of other full-featured netbook offerings out there, at negligibly higher prices. Asus aims for it to be an alternative to both netbooks and tablets.

Asus has also chosen to release the Eee PC X101 with MeeGo

onboard, not Windows, or any regular full-featured distro like openSUSE or Ubuntu. Looking at the specifications, which read almost like a tablet's, we realize nothing else but MeeGo might work – with just 8GB of built-in storage space (SSD) and 1GB of RAM. As many folks in the industry have observed, this netbook is a hybrid of a tablet and a regular

netbook, unfortunately. No surfeit of ports (with no VGA and Ethernet), no optical drive, and no touchscreen.



The Taiwanese giant apparently intends to provide a fast, rich and intuitive computing experience, while at the same time keeping costs low with the operating system, and hardware. As for storage, a glaring omission, Asus has pre-loaded Dropbox cloud storage for free, allowing users to store some real data.

The Asus Eee PC X101 comes with a choice of an Intel Atom N435 or N455 processor. Other specs include Bluetooth 3.0 connectivity, a webcam, two USB2.0 ports, and a 3-cell battery that promises a four-hour battery life, using Asus' Super Hybrid Engine (SHE). The Eee PC X101 will be available in white, red and brown. **d**

Xperia Play exclusive: FIFA 12 for Android

The hordes of Xperia Play owners across the world can rejoice with the knowledge that EA Mobile's FIFA 12 for Android will be available exclusively for them from the holiday season. The rest – those who own regular Android devices – have to wait till February 12, 2012. The full game for consoles and PCs will launch later this month.

Developed by EA Mobile for Android, EA Sport's FIFA 12 has been optimized for the "first PlayStation certified smartphone," capable of running at 60fps on its graphics processor. The Android version of the game sports improved audio, commentary and crowd chants. **d**